

Chapter 32-1

Haizhou City¹ rarely had good weather in autumn. The sun hung high, the sky was bright and clear, with occasional white clouds floating in the azure sky, scattered by the warm, gentle breeze.

A large group of people stood under the canopy. Li Ran was instructing the cameraman to keep the footage good and make sure to capture Zhao Ying beautifully.

The photographer was a fan of Zhao Ying and sheepishly scratched the back of his head with a laugh, "Our Yingying is so beautiful, she looks gorgeous no matter how we film her."

Zhao Ying's assistant stood by with a water cup waiting, while other artists' areas were equally bustling.

The staff were busy coordinating while trembling with fear about how to deal with the angry director.

But Zhao Ying casually pointed toward Liang Shi's direction and suggested letting her act.

The originally noisy film crew suddenly felt like someone had pressed the pause button, as everyone looked over in unison.

But there were too many people under the canopy.

For a moment, they couldn't tell which person Zhao Ying was pointing at, but after everyone scanned the people inside, they immediately understood.

Probably only that face could make Zhao Ying personally nominate someone.

Despite wearing only a simple, plain business suit—an apricot-pink blazer paired with loose wide-leg pants and five-centimeter light-colored heels, with her hair casually tied in a ponytail—it couldn't conceal her outstanding temperament at all.

Tall enough, elegant enough, and beautiful enough.

Even when she stood there unsmiling, appearing cold and unapproachable, she seemed more commanding than Chen Liuying, the so-called "Nation's Number One Dominant Alpha."

That face was a landmark in itself.

The director obviously noticed too and inquired, "Who is that?"

"Someone from BARE here for an interview," Zhao Ying said. "As long as she's pretty enough, what does it matter where she's from?"

Director: "..."

"She doesn't know how to act," the director frowned. "We can't just pull any random person onto set, right?"

"As if Lu Ci² knows how to act," Zhao Ying mercilessly mocked the actress who had stood them up.
"With that silicone face, what can she do besides blinking and showing cleavage? I could pull a dog from the street and it would have more spirit than her."

Director: "..."

The director wavered.

He didn't really want to agree, but looking at that face, it was really hard to refuse.

"Why don't you ask?" the director said. "See if she's willing to act?"

"She was just staring at us acting with her eyes practically popping out," Zhao Ying said. "Director, your people-reading skills aren't great."

Director: "...?"

He had just been busy explaining the scene!

Zhao Ying waved at Liang Shi, "Little sister, come over here."

Liang Shi: "?"

Although she had just made eye contact with Zhao Ying, she didn't dare assume 100% that Zhao Ying was calling her.

She pointed at her own nose, "Me?"

Zhao Ying nodded, "Yes, the prettiest one."

Liang Shi: "..."

Her foot, which had already stepped forward, retracted halfway.

"Yes, you," Zhao Ying said again. "Why are you so lacking in confidence?"

Liang Shi: "..."

What did this have to do with confidence?

With a hundred and eighty people on set, when you say "the prettiest one," what if it wasn't her?
How embarrassing would that be?

Zhao Ying's assistant nudged Liang Shi's arm, "Go on, Sister Ying is calling you."

Liang Shi glanced at Li Ran, who gave her a thumbs up and whispered, "Seize the opportunity."

Having received Li Ran's approval, Liang Shi walked over.

"Little sister, want to act?" Zhao Ying was much more outgoing than Zhao Xuning. She proactively introduced, "A villain role. I think you're quite suitable."

"Yingying, are you kidding me?" the director said. "With this kind of temperament playing a villain, it's not convincing at all. Let's find someone else."

"Didn't you just think she was quite suitable?" Zhao Ying raised an eyebrow, bold and unrestrained. "Beautiful people should play villains—that's what makes it compelling, playing that kind of character people love and hate at the same time."

After Zhao Ying finished speaking, she paused and suddenly looked at Liang Shi again, "But this little sister, I always feel like I've seen you somewhere before."

"Any pretty girl, you feel like you've met before," the director teased from the side.

Zhao Ying shrugged, "Can't help it, I'm attracted to beauty."

They stood there discussing enthusiastically, but the director still felt uneasy and asked Liang Shi, "Have you acted before?"

Liang Shi: "..."

Yes, I have. I'm a veteran actor.

She kept a straight face and deceived her heart: "No experience."

The original body's past "glorious achievements" were all known to Zhao Xuning, and as her cousin, Zhao Ying could find out everything with just one inquiry. She still had to keep it hidden.

"Well then..." the director hesitated. "I should contact Wang Qiang instead. She's at a nearby film crew, I can have her come over for a cameo."

"Wang Qiang with that innocent look can only play idol drama female leads. Put her in a suit and she looks like a child wearing adult clothes. What kind of villain could she play? And you want to ask Director Wang for someone? What are you thinking?" Zhao Ying scoffed lightly. "I think this little sister is quite suitable. She looks like she has the aura of someone who can act."

Liang Shi: "..."

The director was still hesitating. Zhao Ying gave him a shot of confidence: "When have I ever been wrong about people?"

"Fine. Let's go with her," the director said. "Let's try first."

"I object." Chen Liuying, who had just gone to take a phone call, returned to find the situation had changed to this.

It was already annoying enough to see Xu Qingzhu's wife here, and now the director wanted her to act? And opposite her, no less. This was too ridiculous.

"Liuying." The director explained the situation to her, then persuaded, "Let her try first, otherwise you won't be able to wrap up today either."

"Are you threatening me?" Chen Liuying frowned. "I only have two scenes left, but you can't find someone like this to act opposite me, can you? Are you looking down on me or trying to ruin the entire drama? She's never acted a day in her life, isn't from a professional background—what could she possibly act?"

"Anyway, she's only doing two scenes with you, the rest are all with me." Zhao Ying glanced at her sideways. "If she can act with me, why can't she act with you? Meaning she's worthy of me but not you?"

Chen Liuying was left speechless.

In the entertainment industry, this kind of place where the strong prey on the weak and seniority matters, Zhao Ying had debuted earlier than her and was stronger than her. Wherever they met, she had to respectfully call her "Sister Ying."

Moreover, she was a socialite with the Zhao family backing her.

Someone of Chen Liuying's grassroots background couldn't compare.

She immediately apologized, "Sister Ying, that's not what I meant."

"Then what did you mean?" Zhao Ying scoffed lightly. "If you think she can't act, then have the screenwriter delete your two scenes, or find a body double. Just don't delay your wrap-up."

"Sister Ying." Chen Liuying explained, "I think having a random person who doesn't understand the industry act is disrespectful to drama."

"Using you would be respectful?" Zhao Ying rolled her eyes. "May I ask which school you graduated from? Are you professionally trained? What was your ranking?"

Chen Liuying: "..."

"My teacher is..." Chen Liuying hadn't finished speaking when she was interrupted. Bai Weiwei came running over and immediately apologized: "Sorry Teacher Zhao, Liuying is just considering the crew's interests, thinking using a newcomer who's never acted isn't appropriate. She didn't mean to offend you."

"Why did you come over directly?" Chen Liuying looked at her with an unfriendly tone. "Didn't I tell you to wait in the car?"

Bai Weiwei tugged at her and apologized to Zhao Ying again, "Teacher Zhao, I'm sorry. Liuying is still new to the entertainment industry and doesn't understand. Please don't take it to heart."

"She's already an adult, how much longer does she plan to not understand? Learn virtue before learning art. Some people, if their art isn't refined, should at least have good character. A person can't be lacking in both areas, right?" Zhao Ying had already started mocking, her arrogant face clearly expressing—this old lady just looks down on people like you who don't understand anything but still pretend everywhere.

Bai Weiwei could only apologize, "Sorry Teacher Zhao, Liuying only has two scenes left. We'll act them out properly."

"Whatever," Zhao Ying said. "If you don't want to act, just delete and modify the scenes. It's not like you're doing this for the first time."

Bai Weiwei: "..."

Bai Weiwei felt hurt inside but still smiled on her face.

Footnotes:

¹ Haizhou City: The fictional city where the story takes place

² Lu Ci: The actress who stood up the film crew